

Germany — Student Visa & Study Abroad Guide

Updated: September 2026

Important: This is general educational information, not legal, immigration or financial advice. Visa rules, fees, financial thresholds, processing times and document requirements can change. Always verify the current official authority and institution requirements before applying.

Official immigration resources

Visa guidance: <https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service>

Immigration / study information: <https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service>

At a glance

Visa / route	National visa for study / student residence pathway
Common intakes	Winter semester is the main intake; selected programmes also start in summer.

Typical student visa pathway

1. Choose an eligible programme and institution.
2. Apply through the institution or the required application platform and obtain admission evidence.
3. Prepare financial, health-insurance, passport and other supporting evidence.
4. Submit the national visa application through the responsible German mission/current application route.
5. After arrival, complete local registration and residence formalities within the applicable deadlines.

Common supporting documents

- Passport
- Admission letter/notification
- Proof of financing such as the currently accepted route
- Health-insurance evidence
- Academic records
- Language certificate where required
- Visa forms, photographs and additional mission-specific documents

Germany: planning your study application

Admission and visa are separate decisions

A university offer does not by itself guarantee a visa. First confirm the exact programme admission conditions and deadline; then follow the current immigration route and evidence requirements for your nationality and circumstances.

Study planning checklist

- Check whether the programme is taught in English or German.
- Review application routes such as uni-assist where the institution uses them.
- Compare tuition and semester contributions plus living costs.

After arrival

- Register your address where required.
- Arrange the residence permit process if applicable.
- Open/arrange required banking and insurance services.
- Maintain enrolment and residence conditions.

Before submitting your visa application

- Check passport validity and identity details.
- Use the latest official application form/process for your country of residence.
- Make sure names, dates and education history are consistent across documents.
- Keep copies of submitted forms, receipts, appointment confirmations and supporting evidence.
- Check whether documents need certified translation and whether originals must be presented.
- Review the exact visa conditions after grant before travelling.

Useful official links

- [Official visa guidance](https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service) — <https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service>
- [Official immigration/study information](https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service) — <https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/en/visa-service>

ViaSphere counsellor checklist

Use this page as a preparation worksheet. The exact evidence depends on the student, programme, nationality and current rules.

Area	Check	Status
Course	Programme, duration, level and campus confirmed	■
University	Official programme/admissions page reviewed	■
English test	Accepted test and minimum section/overall scores checked	■
Academic documents	Transcripts/certificates and translations checked	■
Funds	Current official financial evidence requirements checked	■
Passport	Validity and personal details checked	■
Accommodation	Plan/evidence prepared if required	■
Insurance/health	Current requirement checked	■
Visa application	Current official route and forms checked	■
Arrival	Registration/orientation/travel plan prepared	■

Official-source rule

If this guide conflicts with an official immigration authority, embassy/consulate, university or testing-provider page, follow the current official source. ViaSphere should not be treated as the issuing authority for any visa or admission decision.